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Become a Growing Church

A Model Church

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A Model Church

In the preceding articles, we have offered a number of practical suggestions designed to help your church grow both in depth and in breadth — becoming a community marked by genuine transformation and vibrant hope in Christ.

You may choose to incorporate some of these elements and the accompanying resources from Jesus Online Ministries, even if you are not yet prepared to adopt them all. Change is rarely easy. We grow comfortable with familiar routines, yet without intentional change, we cannot expect different outcomes. If the current patterns are not producing the fruit you long to see, a fresh approach may be what the Lord is inviting.

What follows is one example of how a church might revise its Sunday gathering to weave together the core principles we have discussed. This represents a significant shift, so we recommend presenting it humbly to the congregation as a three-month trial. At the end of that season, evaluate together — under the Spirit's guidance — whether to continue or adjust. Such a step can be taken prayerfully, with grace and unity.

This proposed order of service is crafted to continually reinforce the transformational truths of the gospel that we so easily forget. In a world that daily pulls us away from God's highway of holiness and hope, we need regular, Spirit-empowered reminders of who God is and who we are in Christ. Each element is designed to create a unique church experience that fosters lasting transformation in the lives of every attendee.

A Proposed Unique Church Order of Service

1. **Welcome** (unscripted, warm, and personal). *Purpose:* To greet one another in the love of Christ and create an atmosphere of genuine belonging.
2. **Core Identity Statement.** *Purpose:* To clearly declare the church's identity for newcomers and to reinforce it for longtime members. For example: "We are a hope-centered church devoted to transformational teaching, so that you may become all that God created you to be and fulfill all He created you to do."
3. **Transition to Hope Video.** *Purpose:* To gently shift everyone's focus from the cares and distractions of the week to the presence, power, and resources of God.

Suggested script: “As we gather together this morning, many of us have stepped out of a week marked by various struggles, difficulties, and challenges. In the midst of these, it can be difficult to turn our minds from those distractions and fully focus on the Lord. So let us begin by turning our hearts toward Him through a short video. It will help us refocus on God and the abundant resources He provides, as we entrust our challenges to His faithful care.”

4. **Show a Hope Video.** *Purpose:* To captivate hearts and minds with one of the seventeen videos from the “**Hope in Times of Crisis**” series, reminding the congregation of God’s immediate and sufficient grace for every circumstance.
5. **Personal Takeaway.** *Purpose:* To model how to apply biblical truth personally and encourage the congregation to do the same. (The pastor or leader briefly shares, in their own words, one key insight from the video.)
6. **Congregation Prayer Requests.** *Purpose:* To invite the community to share burdens and needs openly.
7. **Small-Group Prayer.** *Purpose:* To practice relational prayer, build community, and anchor every request in the truth of who God is and who we are in Him. (The congregation breaks into small groups to pray for the shared requests. At the same time, the screen gently displays an attribute of God along with a corresponding characteristic of our new identity in Christ — serving as timely reminders and reasons for praise.)
8. **Communion or Baptisms** (optional).
9. **Worship and/or Praise Songs.** *Purpose:* To respond to God’s goodness with wholehearted adoration and thanksgiving.
0. **Transformational Sermon.** *Purpose:* To equip believers with truth that renews the mind and shapes daily life. (A message rooted in Scripture that connects directly to the **building blocks of Christian maturity**.)
1. **Prayer and/or Devotion Songs.** *Purpose:* To respond to the preached Word with surrender, commitment, and renewed devotion to Christ.
2. **Communion or Baptisms** (alternate time slot).
3. **Closing Promise.** *Purpose:* To send the congregation forth with a fresh assurance of God’s faithfulness that they can carry into the week. (The congregation joins together in reciting a Bible promise, projected on the screen, that has been thoughtfully chosen to reinforce the sermon’s theme. This promise is drawn from the rich collection of “Bible Promises for Hope” available in the Jesus Online App.)

This model is not intended as a rigid formula, but as a flexible framework through which the Holy Spirit can work more deeply in your midst. May the Lord grant you wisdom, courage, and unity as you seek His leading for the unique calling He has placed on your church family. As you step forward in obedience, may you witness the joy of lives truly transformed for His glory.

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Thank you for downloading this free resource!

We're grateful you've taken this step in your spiritual journey. Your growth in Christ encourages us, and we pray this has been a blessing—strengthening your faith, deepening your understanding of God's Word, and equipping you to live for His glory.

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Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

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